



Samsung microcodes

In a creative ad campaign, Samsung hides microcodes that can be deciphered to win an S20 Ultra. <https://digit.in/apr20-35>



Xbox graphics code leaked

A hacker has stolen and released test files from the Xbox Series X and AMD Navi 10 source code. <https://digit.in/apr20-36>

Sony WI-1000XM2

Simplicity and flair combined in one

Sony has built a name for itself, with audio products featuring ANC technology and Sony's signature warm, pleasing sound. The Sony WI-1000XM2 neckband-style wireless earphones have a lot to prove priced at an exorbitant ₹24,990. Let's see how they fare.

Build and design

Significantly improving upon the design of the Sony WI-1000X, the Sony WI-1000XM2 looks and feels more premium due to the flexible, matte-black silicone neckband. The silicone neckband extends on both sides to meet the plastic modules. The overall design is simple, understated and minimalistic, however, the copper Sony logos do pop out aesthetically. Flat, tangle-resistant, black wires connect the modules to the earbuds. The left wire features an in-line remote which consists of the microphone, volume up and down controls, a multi-function button and a customisable action button. The buttons' tactility is superb and they click quite satisfyingly.

Coming to the earbuds, they are slightly angled and fit extremely securely within the ear canal. This is due to the selection of eartips Sony has provided, which include form-fitting foam tips. The earphones also feature magnetic housings which attach them together when idle. The magnets, however, seem to be quite weak on the buds.

Sony also throws in an exceptional carrying case in the box. It is a fabric-clad hard case with a copper chain.

We used the earphones in the gym and they stayed put in our ears through workouts and runs. The earphones are not rated sweatproof, still, we did encounter any problems using them during sweat-inducing workouts.

Features

Sony packs the QN1 processor along with dual microphones in these buds to enhance the ANC performance. It



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manages to eliminate most low rumbles and constant sounds. It does a commendable job minimising voices and the hum of ACs, which makes it great for office settings. The earphones also come with Sony's Atmospheric Pressure Optimising feature. There's also Ambient Mode which enhances background sounds.

Then there's everything (almost) you'd expect from a pair of earphones costing over ₹20,000, such as Bluetooth v.5.0, an accompanying app with an EQ, support for codecs such as LDAC, AAC and SBC, USB Type C charging and more. Some misses include no IP rating and no auto-pause/play functionality.

A wide array of features are accessible via the Sony Headphones Connect app. You can set up 'smart' sound modes which Sony has dubbed 'Adaptive Sound Control'. The earphones can detect your current activity (Staying, Walking, Running, Commute) and apply the appropriate Ambient Sound or Noise Cancelling settings.

Lastly, the battery life is quite decent, but nothing to write home about. The company 10 hours of battery life. We managed to squeeze out around 9-9.5 hours without ANC on and approximately 7.5 hours with ANC turned on.

Performance

Powered by an HD Hybrid Driver setup, the Sony WI-1000XM2 shows its worth when it comes to audio performance. The sound profile, however, lacks a bit of rumble and thump when it comes to bass. It lacks drive, even though the bass is actually extremely accurate and doesn't distort even at high volumes. In some predominantly bass-y tracks, such as *Another One Bites the Dust* by Queen, the bass response sounds timid. The accuracy of the mids is superb. Instruments in this range sound dynamic and lively while still keeping every bit of detail possible. Vocals, both male and female, sound superb. In *Hysteria* by Muse, the vocals manage to stand out despite the cacophony of instruments.

The highs are splendid, for the most part as well, with a seamless roll-off and minimal distortion. Sometimes though, sibilants (S and T sound) can lack detail. The soundstage is a bit wider than you'd expect from in-ears. Imaging, unfortunately, was a bit lacking in quality for us. We found that in crowded tracks such as *Selkies* by BTBAM, the instruments often overlapped each other.

Bottomline

If you loosen your purse strings for the Sony WI-1000XM2, you will possess a great-sounding pair of earphones which will give you little to complain about. Apart from the strictly mediocre battery life of 10 hours and the slightly timid bass response, there's little to complain about. If you are looking for in-ears, the Sony WI-1000XM2 wireless earphones are certainly a wise choice for audio enthusiasts and even some audiophiles.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

HEADPHONE TYPE: Closed, Hybrid | DRIVER UNIT: Hybrid | MAGNET: Neodymium | FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 20Hz to 20kHz | DSEE HX: yes | WEARING STYLE: Neckband | PASSIVE OPERATION: Yes | BATTERY LIFE: Max. 10 hours (NC ON), Max. 12 hours (Ambient Sound Mode), Max. 15 hours (NC OFF) | BATTERY CHARGE TIME: 3.5 hours | BLUETOOTH VERSION: 5.0 | RANGE: 10m (33 feet)

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